

LUXURY RESIDENTIAL

Portfolio

*Selected works in high-end residential,
historic renovation, and custom construction.*

Michael Colenso

CONSTRUCTION PROJECT MANAGER · SEATTLE, WA

APPROACH

Building for the discerning few.

A practice grounded in craftsmanship, trust, and quiet precision.

Luxury residential work is a relationship business first and a construction business second. Over eighteen years and more than \$300M in delivered projects, I have built my practice around one conviction: that discerning clients deserve a builder who communicates with clarity, protects the design intent, and treats every detail as if it were their own.

My portfolio spans ultra-high-net-worth residences in Seattle and the Bahamas, custom high-rise apartment buildouts, historic adaptive reuse, and boutique multifamily developments. Across each, the throughline is the same — rigorous preconstruction, a disciplined approach to change, and an unwavering advocacy for the owner's vision.

I work best where the stakes are personal: where the drawings are ambitious, the finishes are unforgiving, and the client expects a builder who can quietly absorb complexity so they don't have to.

“Fostering a culture of trust and collaboration through consistent advocacy, fairness, diligence, and transparency.”

— GUIDING PRINCIPLE

AT A GLANCE

18+ years — construction leadership
\$300M+ — delivered project value
Zero — recordable safety incidents
2 continents — Seattle · Bahamas
Trusted advisor — to UHNW clientele

BY THE NUMBERS

A practice measured in outcomes.

Figures drawn from the projects featured in this portfolio.

\$300M+

DELIVERED PROJECT
VALUE

Across residential, mixed-use, and historic renovation.

18 yrs

CONSTRUCTION LEAD-
ERSHIP

From field engineer to senior project manager.

Zero

RECORDABLE INCI-
DENTS

Across 24-month \$12M podium build at 2210 Eastlake.

\$15M+

LUXURY RESIDENTIAL

UHNW projects in Seattle and the Bahamas, 2017–2022.

2 mo

EARLY DELIVERY

\$40M Hyatt Place turnaround via Last Planner System.

15%

FASTER SCHEDULE

Barton Senior Residences — lean pull-planning.

\$6M+

NEGOTIATED CHANGES

The Alaska Building — relationship preserved throughout.

3 + 2

REFERRALS & REPEATS

From ultra-high-net-worth clients at Toth Construction.

2

NATIONAL AWARDS

Eagle Award and Northwest Construction — historic.

Featured projects.

Six case studies spanning custom homes, high-rise residences, and historic conversion.

Private Residences at Baker's Bay

Abaco, Bahamas · 2017 – 2018

Portfolio

PROJECT MANAGER

SCOPE Construction of multiple luxury vacation homes within an exclusive private island community for ultra-high-net-worth members of Discovery Land Company.

CHALLENGE Remote island logistics, fragile supply chains, international customs, and a clientele expecting the standards of a five-star resort delivered to a private residence.

APPROACH Established strategic vendor partnerships to ensure material availability despite supply-chain constraints; implemented a dedicated customs and logistics workflow; coordinated craftspeople across international borders while preserving a white-glove on-site experience.

OUTCOME Delivered multiple homes meeting Discovery Land's exacting quality standards while reducing procurement delays by 30% relative to baseline island-construction benchmarks.

ULTRA HIGH NET WORTH · INTERNATIONAL · LUXURY RESIDENTIAL · PRIVATE ISLAND · CUSTOM HOMES

Toth Construction — UHNW Residential Portfolio

Seattle, WA · 2020 – 2022

\$8M+

PROJECT MANAGER

SCOPE A portfolio of ultra-high-net-worth residential projects for discerning Seattle clients, coordinated with world-class architects and specialty craftspeople.

CHALLENGE Clients with exacting aesthetic standards, bespoke finishes with long lead times, and an expectation of trusted-advisor discretion across every interaction with designers, vendors, and household staff.

APPROACH Cultivated trusted-advisor relationships through transparent weekly reporting and proactive issue escalation; developed detailed finish schedules and mock-up programs; managed specialty trades including stone, millwork, lighting, and integrated home systems.

OUTCOME Earned 3 client referrals and 2 repeat engagements during tenure — the clearest measure of trust in the luxury market — while delivering each residence on schedule.

ULTRA HIGH NET WORTH · CUSTOM RESIDENTIAL · CLIENT EXPERIENCE · CRAFTSMANSHIP · SPECIALTY TRADES

57th-Floor Custom Residence

Seattle, WA · 2021

High-rise
PROJECT MANAGER

SCOPE Custom apartment buildout on the 57th floor of an active high-rise tower, integrating luxury finishes with base-building systems during occupancy of surrounding floors.

CHALLENGE Operating inside a live high-rise required strict access control, careful material staging via freight elevators, and coordination with building engineering to avoid disrupting neighbors or base-building systems.

APPROACH Developed a meticulous logistics plan around freight-elevator windows; phased noisy work around residential quiet hours; integrated custom millwork, stone, and smart-home systems with the existing MEP backbone.

OUTCOME Delivered a fully custom residence without disruption to the surrounding building community, with zero complaints logged through building management.

HIGH-RISE · CUSTOM INTERIORS · OCCUPIED BUILDING · LUXURY RESIDENTIAL

Temple Lofts — Historic Masonic Temple

Long Beach, CA · 2006

\$25M
PROJECT ENGINEER → PROJECT MANAGER

SCOPE Seismic retrofit and full renovation of a historic Masonic Temple, converting ceremonial spaces into luxury loft apartments while preserving character-defining interior features.

CHALLENGE A complex seismic retrofit of unreinforced masonry, integration of modern MEP systems without compromising ornate plasterwork, and a regulatory environment requiring historic tax credits and SHPO review.

APPROACH Collaborated with preservation architects and structural engineers to develop retrofit solutions honoring the building's heritage; secured historic tax credits and Mills Act benefits; phased work to protect character-defining ceremonial spaces.

OUTCOME Delivered on schedule with no regulatory delays; successful lease-up demonstrated the market appetite for historic luxury residences.

HISTORIC CONVERSION · ADAPTIVE REUSE · LUXURY LOFTS · SEISMIC RETROFIT · TAX CREDITS

The Alaska Building Renovation

Seattle, WA · 2009

\$12M+

PROJECT MANAGER

SCOPE Complete renovation and seismic retrofit of a 1904 iconic historic office building in downtown Seattle — a showcase of preservation craftsmanship.

CHALLENGE Preserving the building's historic character while implementing modern seismic standards and building systems; navigating stringent historic-preservation requirements; absorbing significant owner-directed scope changes without straining the relationship.

APPROACH Worked hand-in-glove with preservation architects, structural engineers, and SHPO; negotiated and executed \$6M+ in scope changes while maintaining a cooperative owner relationship; documented each preservation decision for the historic record.

OUTCOME Recognized with two national awards: the 2009 ABC Eagle Award for Best Historic Restoration, and Northwest Construction's Best Historic Renovation.

HISTORIC RESTORATION · AWARD WINNER · SEISMIC RETROFIT · DOWNTOWN SEATTLE · CHANGE MANAGEMENT

2210 Eastlake Apartments

Seattle, WA · 2022 – 2024

\$12M

PROJECT MANAGER

SCOPE Boutique 8-story, 57-unit podium-style multifamily development in Seattle's Eastlake neighborhood — 35,000 SF, Type III/V wood frame over concrete podium.

CHALLENGE A tight urban site requiring careful coordination with neighboring properties, city agencies, and a design-forward owner targeting a premium lease-up in a discerning neighborhood.

APPROACH Managed full P&L, 18 subcontractors, and direct owner relationship from groundbreak through certificate of occupancy; implemented a comprehensive safety program and maintained open communication with neighbors.

OUTCOME Delivered on schedule with zero recordable safety incidents across the 24-month project, and strong subcontractor relationships preserved throughout.

BOUTIQUE MULTIFAMILY · PODIUM CONSTRUCTION · URBAN INFILL · ZERO INCIDENTS · OWNER
RELATIONSHIP

How I serve discerning clients.

A focused set of capabilities refined across eighteen years of residential work.

PRECONSTRUCTION & PLANNING

Detailed constructability review, realistic cost modeling, and value engineering that respects design intent rather than erasing it.

OWNER REPRESENTATION

Trusted-advisor reporting cadence, transparent budget tracking, and the discretion that private-client work demands.

SPECIALTY TRADE COORDINATION

Long-standing relationships with stone, millwork, metalwork, lighting, and integrated-systems specialists across the Pacific Northwest.

SCHEDULE DISCIPLINE

Last Planner System, pull planning, and the kind of week-by-week rigor that delivered a \$40M project two months early.

DESIGN-TEAM COLLABORATION

Direct, respectful partnership with architects and interior designers — protecting the design vision through honest, early conversation.

CHANGE MANAGEMENT

A disciplined, documented approach to change — fair, fast, and built to preserve the owner relationship under pressure.

HISTORIC & ADAPTIVE REUSE

SHPO-level fluency in preservation requirements, seismic retrofit, and the balance between heritage and modern comfort.

QUALITY & PUNCH

Finish-level QC programs, mock-up driven approvals, and a zero-tolerance approach to the last 2% that defines a luxury home.

Envelope

Curtain wall · Stone veneer · IMPs

Structure

Seismic retrofit · Post-tension ·
Wood frame

Interiors

Custom millwork · Natural stone
· Plaster

Sitework

Shoring · Urban logistics · Land-
scape

Systems

Radiant heat · Smart home · AV
integration

Finishes

Mock-ups · Lighting · Specialty
metals

LET US BUILD SOMETHING ENDURING

IN CLOSING

Thank you for your consideration.

I would welcome a conversation about your project — whether it is a custom residence, a historic restoration, or a boutique multifamily development. Every meaningful build begins with a candid, unhurried first conversation.

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BASED IN
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